

# 立教大学 英語 過去問風演習

長文読解 ー 本番想定 (大問 1 題・25 分)

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高校3年～既卒 (立教大学 文系志望)

英語 (長文読解・立教本番レベル)

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## Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) [配点 30 点]

Read the following passage and answer the questions.

The concept of "flow," developed by psychologist Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi, describes a mental state in which a person is fully immersed in an activity, experiencing a sense of energized focus and enjoyment.

(A) People in flow often lose track of time, forget about themselves, and find the activity intrinsically rewarding. Athletes call it "being in the zone"; musicians describe it as "being one with the music."

What conditions produce flow? Csikszentmihalyi identified several key factors. First, the challenge must match the person's skill level. If a task is too easy, boredom results; if too difficult, anxiety. Second, the activity must have clear goals and immediate feedback. Third, the person must be able to concentrate without distraction.

(B) Modern life, however, seems engineered to prevent flow. Smartphones interrupt us constantly. Open-plan offices fragment our attention. Even leisure activities — endless scrolling through social media — fail to engage us deeply because they offer no meaningful challenge.

Yet flow remains accessible to those who deliberately create conditions for it. (C) Reading a difficult book, practicing a musical instrument, solving a complex puzzle, or engaging in skilled conversation can all induce flow. The common element is sustained, focused attention on something challenging enough to demand our full engagement but manageable enough that we can succeed.

Research suggests that people who experience flow regularly report higher levels of happiness and life satisfaction. This is not because flow itself is pleasurable in the moment — many people in flow are too absorbed to feel "pleasure" in the ordinary sense — but because flow gives life meaning and direction.

### Notes:

**flow** — フロー状態

**immersed** — 没頭する

**intrinsically** — 本質的に

**induce** — 引き起こす

## Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) — Questions

**Q1** 1

According to underlined sentence (A), people in flow:

- ① feel bored and distracted
- ② lose track of time and find the activity intrinsically rewarding
- ③ are aware of every passing minute
- ④ only experience flow when paid to do so

**Q2** 2

Which is NOT one of Csikszentmihalyi's identified conditions for flow?

- ① The challenge matches the person's skill level.
- ② Activity has clear goals and immediate feedback.
- ③ The person can concentrate without distraction.
- ④ The activity must be done in a group.

**Q3** 3

What does underlined sentence (B) suggest about modern life?

- ① Modern life is perfectly designed for deep concentration.
- ② Modern life seems designed to prevent flow due to constant interruptions and distractions.
- ③ Modern technology has eliminated the need for flow.
- ④ Open-plan offices increase flow opportunities.

**Q4**

**4**

Which activity is NOT mentioned in underlined sentence (C) as inducing flow?

- ① Reading a difficult book
- ② Practicing a musical instrument
- ③ Watching short videos online
- ④ Solving a complex puzzle

**Q5**

**5**

Why do people who experience flow regularly report higher happiness?

- ① Because flow always feels pleasurable in the moment.
- ② Because flow gives life meaning and direction, even if not always pleasurable in the moment.
- ③ Because flow eliminates all stress.
- ④ Because flow is always profitable.

**Q6**

**6**

The phrase 'in the zone' as used by athletes means:

- ① playing in a designated area
- ② experiencing the same mental state as flow — full immersion and focus
- ③ feeling extreme anxiety
- ④ being distracted

## 解答・解説

| 問 | 解答 | 解説                                                                                                                 |
|---|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | ②  | 【正解】 ② 下線部 (A) は「lose track of time, forget about themselves, and find the activity intrinsically rewarding」と直接対応。 |
| 2 | ④  | 【正解】 ④ 第2段落で挙げられる3条件は (i) 挑戦と技量のマッチ (ii) 明確な目標 + 即時フィードバック (iii) 集中できる環境。「グループでなければならない」は記述なし。                     |
| 3 | ②  | 【正解】 ② 下線部 (B) は modern life がフローを妨げると指摘 → 直後でスマホ・open-plan offices・SNS の無意味なスクロールを列挙。                             |
| 4 | ③  | 【正解】 ③ 下線部 (C) で列挙されるのは: 難しい本を読む / 楽器の練習 / 複雑なパズル / 熟練した会話。「短い動画の視聴」は記述なし (むしろ flow を妨げる例として登場)。                   |
| 5 | ②  | 【正解】 ② 最終段落「flow gives life meaning and direction」+ 「not because flow itself is pleasurable」と一致。                   |
| 6 | ②  | 【正解】 ② 第1段落「Athletes call it 'being in the zone'」= フローの同義語。「being one with the music」(音楽家の表現) と並列して文脈で意味確定。        |